

Annual Report

Events



National Service Scheme
Indian Institute of Technology, Bombay
2017-18

Contents

Introduction	1
Events	2
About the Department	2
Major Activites:	2
Graduating Students' Collection Drive.....	2
Cloth Collection Drive	3
NGO Visits.....	4
Meals Of Content	5
(L)earn a Living	5
Media Coverage and Common Activities	6
Team Events NSS 2017-18	11

Introduction

NSS, IIT Bombay is the most active student volunteer body in the institute in the field of community/social service. Established with a motivation of imbibing in the young students the importance of contributing our bit towards our society, and also to help the students improve their personality through social interaction. The spirit of NSS lies in the indulgence of oneself in service of others without worrying about any rewards and this spirit has been upheld by the team time and again which is an inspiration in itself! With a freshmen volunteer strength of more than 320 and around 100 non-freshmen volunteers, NSS has grown exponentially since its inception. The reach of the activities of NSS is setting new benchmarks, helping beneficiaries in the remotest corners of the entire nation.

NSS, IIT Bombay is the IIT Bombay chapter of National Service Scheme institutionalized by Government of India under the Ministry of Youth Affairs Sports, Government of India. NSS, IIT Bombay has played a key role in making significant contributions for the welfare of society in different dimensions. From the Open Learning Initiative (OLI) benefitting more than 50,000 subscribers with each upload of a new video, donating more than 5000+ kilograms of clothes to the underprivileged kids from slums in Mumbai, extending the Biodiversity mapping initiative to 1200+ trees this year, initiating BMC school visits for sustainability lessons to school-going children after 1.5 years of struggle for permissions, to hosting the first ever All NSS Meet for Mumbai's NSS units and being the first step towards uniting NSS bodies, NSS has been working tirelessly on the path of continuous growth.

Composed of five departments, Educational Outreach, Green Campus, Events, Vikas and National Innovation Club the activities of NSS IIT Bombay are varied and cover almost all aspects of social service. Educating underprivileged students irrespective of language and distance barriers, maintaining the greenery of the campus and improving its richness and diversity, working towards environmental sustainability, improving the life of people, knowing, understanding and solving socio-technological problems are the major activities of NSS IITB.

Spreading happiness through community service has been one of the primary objectives of NSS. With innovative activities across the departments catering to all classes of the campus residents, we try to create small, happy and memorable moments in their lives. And working in NSS itself has been one of the prime sources of happiness for the people associated with us. Bringing to light the stories of the different campus residents who are responsible for its smooth functioning and also the stories of our volunteers has also been a major and a very popular activity undertaken by NSS, IITB.

Events

About the Department:

Events is the department of NSS, IIT Bombay that believes in the 'Upliftment of the poor section of society through change in lifestyle.' We at Events strive to ensure that various activities that are performed to achieve the above-mentioned initiatives, are undertaken in an extensive and optimized manner. From the students at the Aman Day center in the institute to the tribal areas in the outskirts of the city, the department has had many beneficiaries and with new initiatives kicking in, the number is bound to increase.

Major Activities:

Graduating Students' Collection Drive:

"Before this, we used to sleep on the ground...but now, things will change"- A Construction Worker in Ambernath

Every year, the institute witnesses the passing out of a large no. of students, both at the under- graduation and the post-graduation level. The students that pass out, often leave their bulky belongings, like mattresses, pillows, buckets etc. here, as they are not needed anymore. The Graduation Collection Drive(GCD) was started with the thought that these items, if collected and donated, could be effectively used to benefit a large section of the society i.e. a complete village or a colony. The activity is generally done by the Activity Associates of the departments, under the supervision of the Department Heads. Volunteers are included in the donation activities Every year, the initiative is held in the months of May and June, as it is the time when the academic year ends and the students leave. This year, the donation activities were held in the slum areas of Ambernath.



Cloth Collection Drive:

As the name suggests, the initiative acts as a link between the donation-interested people in the institute to the beneficiaries by donation of clothes from the former to latter. As the flagship activity of the Events Department, the Cloth Collection Drive (CCD) is held over the course of the complete academic year. It is further broken down to 2 phases- Phase 1, held in October involves collection from the student hostels, which includes making of interactive donation boxes by the volunteers, putting them up in visible, common areas in each hostel followed by regular collection of the donated items. Phase 2, held in March, is conducted in the professor residences, the volunteers are divided into specific groups and allotted specific areas, where at first publicity posters are put up, followed by 4-5 visits in the areas to collect clothes from the interested people. In both the phases, segregation and sorting of clothes are done by the volunteers themselves. The activity is most enjoyed by volunteers as they themselves are responsible for all the collection, the sorting and the donation activities done in the initiative. This year, the initiative, especially Phase 1 witnessed a huge growth in terms of the volume of clothes donated. The phase 1 donations were again carried out in the slum areas of Ambarnath, with the help of The Front Labour Union, over the course of two visits. The head of the front labour union said the following about our initiative:

"You all are doing a great work. I have never seen college students affecting the lives of such a large group of people in this type of effective and efficient way"

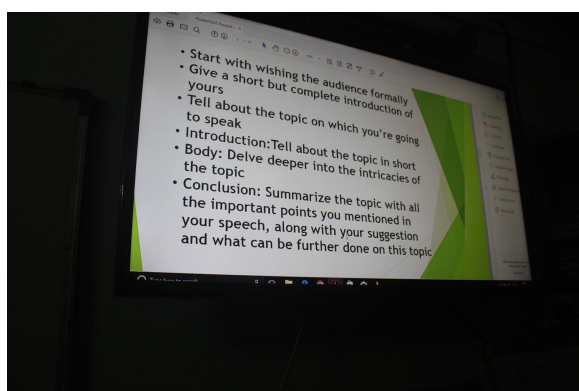


NGO Visits:

"I can literally come and teach here daily, I truly love it!!" - An enthusiastic volunteer after a session

Events department believes that apart from learning the basic subjects such as Maths and Science, a good bit of talking sense and correct use of language is also required to help students tackle the daily endeavors of life. Keeping this in mind, our volunteers visit different NGOs in and around the institute to inculcate in students, the basics of vocabulary and communication skills. The NGOs currently involved with us are The Logic Centre and Community Welfare Association(LCCWA) and Asha. The volunteers have a well prepared teaching module dedicated for the same and sessions are conducted over the weekend to teach different aspects of the above-mentioned topics, followed by an interactive activity to include the children and re-explaining the concept through direct participation. Thus, it is a fun activity for both the children and the volunteers.

"Next time also, you come. I have many doubts, I will ask you to clear them and teach me other things." - A student at Asha



Meals Of Content:

"Your initiative is truly innovative and new. I donate every day and love to do so."- A post graduate student studying in the institute

Meals of Content(MoC) is a new initiative launched by the Events department this year, to cash in on the fact that the canteens do not always provide the change and the buyer must sometime reluctantly take different items with them. The MoC provided an alternate platform for the same, purchasing biscuits from that change and donating it the donation boxes provided there by NSS. The first activity of the academic year for the volunteers, this included making of interactive donation boxes, coaxing the various canteen owners to allow the boxes to be kept in canteens, and then regular collection by the volunteers. This year, the initiative was held in some of the department canteens and some hostel canteens. As a trial run, the MoC was also held outside the institute, to cater to a more diverse audience. The total collection was close to 300 packets, donated at the Aman Day Care center in the institute and the Akshay Patra supported schools in Thane, as an additive to their morning breakfast. The initiative is planned to be extended and made more effective in the coming years.



(L)earn a Living:

In the working market, there is always a shortage of skilled assistants in the shops. On the other hand, in the slum areas we have people who are qualified enough to work, but not so due to insufficient some extra, edge-providing skills or due to indulgence in bad activities. The initiative tries to act as link between the two. Uptill now, the initiative is not on ground yet, but the back-end job is almost complete. This includes making a completely different interactive teaching module for imparting the required skills, and a survey conducted in the shops of galleria to get an overview of the type of labor force and skill required by different categories of shopkeepers.

Media Coverage and Common Activities

Media Coverage:

NSS, IIT Bombay has always been setting an example in diverse spheres of social welfare activities and is playing a major role in making common people aware about the importance of harmony in the society, the nation and the world. The International as well as Indian Media plays a huge role in this direction by covering our activities and events for all the common people to know. We genuinely feel reaching out with our activities to the common people through media helps create an awareness among people regarding the importance of self-contribution for the welfare and upliftment of the society. Some of our activities were published in national and international news reports.

NSS volunteers collect 4,000 kg of clothes for donation

Will be handed over to NGOs who will oversee their distribution to the needy

SHREYA RAMACHANDRAN
MUMBAI

National Service Scheme (NSS) members at IIT-Bombay have collected over 4,000 kg of old and unused clothes for donation this year. With the fifth edition of the collection drive continuing till June, the figure may go up.

The drive takes place in three parts. Last October, clothes were collected from the hostel inmates. NSS volunteers placed cardboard collection bins in common areas, where students could leave their unused clothes. In April, volunteers approached the quarters of professors and non-teaching staff for toys and old clothes.

And in May, graduating students can donate clothes, mattresses, bedding, and possessions they do not need as they leave the campus.

"Graduating students always have clothes they don't need, because they can't take their possessions off the campus. This is a chance for them to donate," said Prathyusha Barre, NSS student coordinator and third-year electrical engineering student.

Clothes are donated to NGOs, including Green Yatra and Kamal Arnav Trust, who then oversee their distribution. "Along with the clothes and other items from IIT, we collect donations from

households and corporates, accumulate them at our warehouse, and segregate them. We then take them to interiors of Maharashtra, especially Adivasi' padas, which are really in need of clothes and utensils. We always get a good response from IIT and it's nice to know that students develop a social conscience that can be moulded when they join the workforce," said Durgesh Gupta, founder-trustee of Green Yatra, and an environmental lawyer and activist.

Students appreciate the chance to prevent wastage. "We accumulate many T-shirts from clubs or events because of their sentimental value, and after a few years,

we stop using them. Our preferences keep changing, so we have many unused clothes. This is a great solution," said Saugata Halder, second-year civil engineering student.

Big hit on campus

"It is quite a hit on the campus, and after the graduating students' contributions, we expect to have collected over 5,000 kg," said Vaidehi Mahajan, events head at NSS and second-year mechanical engineering student. "For our April collection, people had kept clothes ready by March. When we were about to close, professors reached out saying they have more clothes."



Bringing a smile: Clothes collect by NSS volunteers at IIT-Bombay, being handed over to residents of Ambadi Naka in Palghar district in last October. ■SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

The Cloth Collection Campaign covered by the Hindustan Times

NSS, IIT Bombay Reaches New Heights

National Service Scheme (NSS) of IIT Bombay participated in several new activities, while efficiently taking forward the existing social activities with a motive of providing maximum benefits to the underprivileged.

BMC school visits: Under Tarang, the sustainability initiative, a new chapter has been started by NSS. By visiting BMC schools, NSS members hope to promote sustainability among young minds at the grassroot level. NSS now conducts sessions in schools for students of class 7 to 10 to instill amongst them the importance of saving resources, reusing, recycling and incorporating sustainable practices in day-to-day lives. NSS members visited four BMC schools on January 20, 2018. The sessions were fully interactive. Members demonstrated certain working models for better understanding of students.

Biodiversity mapping: White placards tied to large tree trunks is a common sight in IIT Bombay campus. NSS has now initiated phase 2 of 'Biodiversity mapping' project. In the first phase, members identified and marked trees along the 1.5 kms road in the student residential area. More than 400 trees of 70 different species were identified. This time, NSS members reused one-sided blank papers to make the placards and also included a



NSS, IIT Bombay team with students of Jammu and Kashmir

New activities covered in the Campus Diary, IIT Bombay

Common Activities:

The Artistic Impact:

A pen, a brush and a camera. All three of these are powerful tools to shed light on social problems and create awareness among the masses. The Artistic Impact is a nationwide Socio-Art competition conducted by NSS, IIT Bombay with a motivation of capturing the creativity of the young minds of India to highlight social issues. This competition has three segments: 'ThINK', 'Social Canvas', and 'Click for Change'. With a bright start to this initiative last year, we received tremendous participation this year too with participants from states so far as Haryana and Orissa. The winners (3, 3, 10 from Social Canvas, Click for Change and ThINK genres, respectively) were awarded with certificate and official merchandise of NSS, IIT Bombay.



Award winning entry in 'Social Canvas', the judicial system trying to protect women from devils

All NSS Meet:

On April 7th, NSS IIT Bombay organized 'All NSS Meet' for Mumbai units. 13 representatives of other NSS units from different regions of Mumbai attended this event. All participants were overwhelmingly enthusiastic about participating in this event. During the event, we introduced all our activities along with a discussion of what all activities can be carried out collectively to reach out more beneficiaries.

It was followed by a dance performance by Muskaan kids from the NGO LCCWA. It was then followed by the presentations of the other NSS units' for mutual learning. Informal discussions were done during the snacks break from which we came to know the scope of reaching out to them through our activities. Finally, we concluded the event mentioning a few activities that could be taken forward by all the colleges. NSS IIT Bombay is grateful to all these NSS units' for dedicating their precious time and making this event a success. We are looking forward to involve more number of colleges so that services could be extended to maximum regions of Mumbai.



All NSS Meet with the representatives from 6 NSS units in Mumbai

Jammu and Kashmir kids' visit to IIT Bombay:

A day was spent with the 11th class students of Jammu and Kashmir. These kids from Jammu and Kashmir Govt schools came to the institute to know the lifestyle of IITB students and also to know more about the culture here in Mumbai. This was the first time they were coming out of their state.

In this four days of tour, apart from academics and lab visits, they got to know about the various extra-curricular activities that the students here do.

NSS IIT Bombay volunteers thought of engaging them in an institute tour and made them feel happy by letting them interact with NGO kids through Muskaan and Prayog session. So in the first half, kids were taken along for an institute tour starting from Nursery-lakeside-boathouse, after a short orientation. In the second half, we had Fine arts session in the Muskaan and Science experiments in Prayog along with the NGO kids.



NSS Volunteers with kids from Jammu and Kashmir while Institute tour

Invisible Humans of IIT Bombay:

This is a series of posts featuring unheard stories of the people of campus whom majority of the residents know by face but nobody cares about their story. These people make our lives better at the campus and we think it is our duty to bring their stories and their dreams into the light. Our activity associates identified many such people including a Bhutta Stall owner, Dhobi of Hostels, Librarian, SAC store incharge, Assistant Sports officer, friendly mess workers of hostel 10 etc. The student community of IIT Bombay likes these stories of people they see daily and we got positive feedback from them.



Mr. Shankar Gupta (KReSIT Samosa wale) being covered in the series 'Invisible Humans of IIT Bombay'

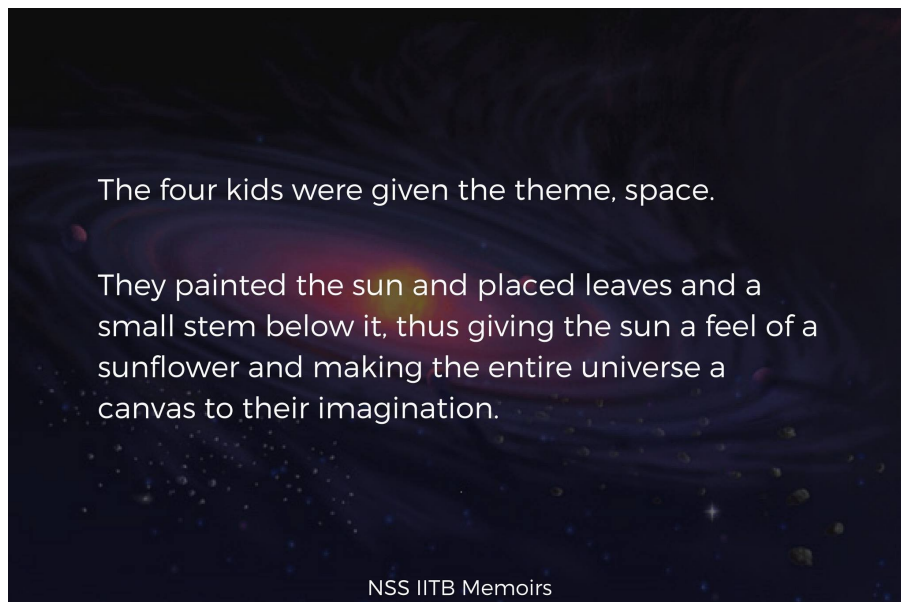
World Menstrual Hygiene Day Awareness:

Menstrual Hygiene is considered as a huge taboo in the Indian society. Considering this, NSS IITB decided to break the taboo about menstrual hygiene by initiating an awareness drive through social media platforms. The awareness drive reached to more than 52,000 people throughout the nation.



Memoirs:

Memoirs are the excerpts from well-written essays by NSS volunteers. Most of these are a way for the volunteers to sit back and cherish the memories they volunteer(s) had.



The four kids were given the theme, space.

They painted the sun and placed leaves and a small stem below it, thus giving the sun a feel of a sunflower and making the entire universe a canvas to their imagination.

NSS IITB Memoirs

Memoirs: Volunteer experience summarised!

Team Events NSS 2017-18

Heads:

Aadarsh Parashar
Vaidehi Mahajan

Activity Associates:

Nautatva Navlakha
Pratyush Ragini Singh
Puneet Nemade
Yash T. Rajan



“Memories once framed shall remain forever”